THE TRAITORS

How tonight's quiz works. Read it once, then enjoy the game.

The idea in 30 seconds

Tonight's quiz has a secret. Before it starts, **one player has been chosen to be the Traitor**. Nobody knows who, except them.

The Traitor will quietly steal points, help some players and hurt others, and send messages to throw you off the scent. Everyone else has to **work out who it is** and **banish them at half time**. Play the quiz as normal: answer well, watch the scores, and keep your eyes open.

> **You might be the Traitor.** If you are, a secret screen will tell you so on your phone, with a 🗡 button that opens your private menu. If you don't see one, you are a Faithful: your job is to catch whoever does.

If you are a Faithful (most of you)

1. **Answer the questions.** Everything else rides on top of the normal quiz.
2. **Watch for the announcements.** When the Traitor steals points, the game stops after the next question and the big screen tells everyone. You won't see who did it, or who they took from, unless you work it out.
3. **Earn a 🛡 shield.** Get **3 questions right in a row** and you earn a shield. It protects you from the Traitor **until you get a question wrong**: their steals and blocks fail against you, and you are told what they tried (it is up to you whether you share it). The Traitor is never told who has a shield.
4. **Look out for messages.** The Traitor can send you a secret message (it appears on your phone between questions) or write to the whole room (a "message from the Traitor" on the big screen). Can you work out who it is? Remember: it might be a bluff.
5. **The Round Table.** After the last question before half time there is a **3-minute discussion**. Talk, accuse, defend. Then everyone votes on their phone for who to banish. The player with the most votes goes **full screen on camera** and tells the room whether they are the Traitor.

6. **The final Round Table, and the 20 Questions.** There is one more vote at the very end. If two Traitors started the second half, whoever is still standing then faces the **Traitors 20 Questions**: ask yes/no questions to find out who they are.

The Round Table: the vote

	If the room is right	If the room is wrong
The Traitor	Banished: loses their power **and 5,000 points**. A **new Traitor** is chosen in secret.	Stays Traitor for the second half, and **earns a 2,000 bonus at the end** (hidden, so the scores don't give them away).
The person chosen	Is the Traitor: see above.	Innocent, so **wrongly accused: loses 3,000 points**.
Players who voted for them	**+2,000 bonus** each.	**Each lose 3,000** too.

The player with the most votes is put on camera, full screen, and says whether they are the Traitor (the Traitor may bluff!). Then the host reveals the truth. If the vote is tied, nobody is chosen.

Recruiting and the 20 Questions

- If the room misses at half time, the Traitor is offered a **recruit**. The person they pick can **join** (and learns who the Traitor is) or **refuse and lose 2,000**. Two Traitors share their powers and must agree each action.
- If the Traitor **is** found at half time, the host picks **two new Traitors**.
- With two Traitors, each fills in an honest list. After the final Round Table the Traitor(s) still in face the **20 Questions**: everyone else asks yes/no questions and can guess a name. With both in, one of their two lists is chosen at random for everyone, and **finding either Traitor wins**.
- **Find a Traitor: +3,000 points.** If most of the room finds them, that Traitor loses 2,000. If they get away with it, they win a 5,000 bonus.
- With a single Traitor all night there is no 20 Questions: the final Round Table is the only chance to catch them.
- **The confessions.** Before the final reveal, up to five people with their camera on come up on the big screen one at a time and say whether they were a Traitor tonight. The first is a Faithful, the rest are picked at random, so a Traitor can come up at any point.

If you are the Traitor

You have a 🗡 **button** on your phone, shown only to you. Its menu works at any time, before a question or while one is running. A power you set while a question is running counts on the next question, not the current one. Please keep your phone to yourself.

Power	How it works
💰 **Steal**	Take **100 to 1,000 points** from one player and give them to someone else, or **keep them yourself** (but points you give yourself are only for show, and come off at the end). You can steal **up to 3 times each half**, and from the same player **once every 15 questions**. A steal on a player with a 🛡 shield fails (and still counts). The Traitor can't see who has one: they find out by trying. After a steal, the game pauses after the next question and the room is told it has happened.
🎁 **Free answer** ×3 a half	Pick a player before a question starts. Their phone pings "The Traitor has gifted you full points for this question", and they score full marks whatever they answer. You can pick yourself. After the question the big screen shows who was gifted (never who did it).
🚫 **Block** ×3 a half	Pick a player before a question starts to keep them out of that question. You can block yourself, to look innocent. The big screen shows who was blocked.
✨ **Double** ×3 a half	Pick anyone, yourself included: their points on the next question count twice.
✋ **Hold**	Automatic on one phone: while you are in your 🗡 menu choosing a steal, a power or a message, the host's secret phone shows "HOLD ON" so they do not rush the next question. It goes the moment you make your choice or leave the menu. Nothing shows on the big screen: only the host's own phone is told. With two phones the automatic hold is off, and a ✋ **Hold** button inside the menu does it by hand (tap it again, or send something, to let go).
📜 **Messages**	Send a short secret message to one player (it appears between questions), or a message to everyone. It arrives as a sealed letter that unfolds on the big screen and every phone. The Traitor gets message starters to fill in.

You can use one of each power per question. The powers act on the next question where everyone answers (not on the group games).

> **With two Traitors:** a list of questions about you opens on your phone at half time. **Be honest.** Tick the ones that are true of you and add your own if you like. It becomes the clue list for the 20 Questions, so the quiz stays fair.

Got another player with you? Your teammate types your **team code** (it starts with **TEAM**: tap 👥 Team on your phone to see it) where the game code goes, to secretly join (still as one team) so one of you can do the answering while the other does the **MURDERING**! Tap **Open the door** in your 🔪 menu (Team tab), let them in, then choose which phone answers and which does the Traitor actions. It is still one player and one name on the scoreboard. The answering phone is alerted to every decision the other phone makes.

Points you give yourself are only for show. A steal, a free answer or a double on yourself looks real on the scoreboard all night, but it is taken off your score at the very end. Use it to look innocent, not to win.

Hidden bonuses. Your +2,000 for escaping the vote and your +5,000 for getting away in the final round are only added at the very end, so nobody sees your score jump.

Quick facts

Steal	100–1,000 points · 3 a half · same victim once every 15 questions
Shield	3 right in a row · kept until you get one wrong
Free answers / blocks / doubles	3 of each for the Traitor every half (they all come back at half time, same Traitor or new)
Keep it live	Every 20 questions the Traitors are nudged to use a power, steal or send a message if they have been quiet (a message in particular, if they have only done steals and powers)
Round Table	3 minutes, then the vote
Right vote	Traitor −5,000 and loses the power · voters +2,000 · new Traitor
Wrong vote	Traitor stays · +2,000 hidden for them · the person chosen and everyone who voted for them lose 3,000
Traitors 20 Questions	Finders +3,000 · caught: Traitor −2,000 · escaped: Traitor +5,000

Tap 📖 **Rules** on your phone to read this again any time. Good luck. Trust no one. 🔪